# The Day of the Lord and Believers

*In contrast to the unbelievers who will face the Day of the Lord, believers are loved, chosen, set apart and appointed to deliverance — so stand fast and hold the apostolic Word.*

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# Where this study fits

*2 Thessalonians · seven studies · this study highlighted*

**01** 1:1–2
**Introduction and Background**

**02** 1:3–12
**Paul's Admiration for the Thessalonians**

**03** 2:1–5
**Confusion Concerning the Coming**

**04** 2:6–12
**The Removal of the Restrainer**

**05** 2:13–17
**The Day of the Lord and Believers**

**06** 3:1–12
**Serving While Waiting**

**07** 3:13–18
**My Brother's Keeper**

**Grace and peace frame the letter (1:2; 3:16–18):** persecution in chapter 1, prophecy in chapter 2, correction in chapter 3.

# Their position — 2:13–14

*2 Thessalonians 2:13–14 · I.A–D*

**Situation · 13a**
**ἀγαπάω** beloved

- Brothers of Paul
- Beloved by the Lord

**Selection · 13b**
**αἱρέομαι** chose

- The Father chose
- The Spirit set apart
- They believed the truth

**Salvation · 13c**
**σωτηρία** deliverance

- Deliverance — here, from the wrath of the Tribulation

**Glorification · 14**
**περιποίησις** obtaining

- Called by “our gospel”
- To share Christ’s glory

“But” (2:13) — they are going to be in it; not you. Verse 12: condemned who did not believe the truth. Verse 13: you believed the truth.

# “God … chose you” — which word?

*2 Thessalonians 2:13b · I.B.1 — The Father chose*

**2 Thess 2:13 — haireomai**
**αἱρέομαι** to pick, choose · G138

- Used of picking fruit
- Elsewhere only Phil 1:22; Heb 11:25
- “From the beginning” of the gospel there
- Chosen to escape the Tribulation

vs

**Ephesians 1:4 — eklegomai**
**ἐξελέξατο** He chose us · election

- “Before the foundation of the world”
- Choosing to eternal life
- The teacher still holds it firmly
- — but doesn’t see it here

The Father chose, the Holy Spirit conferred (“sanctification by the Spirit”), and the Thessalonians concurred (“belief in the truth”).

# Three tenses of sanctification

*2 Thessalonians 2:13 · I.B.2 — “through sanctification by the Spirit”*

**A**

**Past — a position**

Set apart to God the moment we believe

*Paul’s main point here*

**B**

**Present — a process**

Transformed by the Word and the Spirit

*John 17:17 · 2 Cor 3:18*

**C**

**Future — a prospect**

“We shall be like Him”

*1 John 3:2*

**ἁγιασμός** sanctification — here mainly the positional setting apart by the Spirit

**Paul may have all three in mind — but mainly our past sanctification, which placed us into the body of Christ.**

# Salvation means deliverance — from what?

*2 Thessalonians 2:13c · I.C — Their salvation*

**A** **Spiritual**

From sin's penalty, power and presence

**B** **Physical**

"They were healed" — delivered from blindness, lameness

**C** **Circumstances**

Peter sinking: "Lord, save me!" (Matt 14:30)

**D** **Matthew 24:13**

Enduring through the Tribulation — not keeping eternal life

**E** **1 Thess 5:9**

"Not appointed to wrath, but to obtain salvation"

✓ **Here · 2:13**

Deliverance from the wrath of the Tribulation

# Stand fast and hold the Word

*2 Thessalonians 2:15 · II.A — Our responsibility*

**A**

**Hear it**

No daydreaming

*first*

**B**

**Check it**

Make sure it's the Word of God

*"show me"*

**C**

**Review it**

Get it in your head

**D**

**Believe it**

If you believe it, you'll do it

**E**

**Share it**

You understand it better when you help someone else

## Hold the traditions

**παράδοσις** G3862

- By word — what Paul taught in person
- By epistle — what he wrote

## Apostolicity = canonicity

- When the apostles were gone, the canon was closed
- John 14:26; 16:13

# Our resources

*2 Thessalonians 2:16–17 · II.B — Their source and content*

### The source · 16a

- “Our Lord Jesus Christ Himself, and our God and Father”
- “Who” — singular: one God
- According to His riches (Phil 4:19)

### God’s love · 16b

**παράκλησις · ἐλπίς** consolation · hope

- Everlasting consolation
- A good hope, by grace
- No charge

### God’s life · 17

**στηρίζω** establish · G4741

- Comforts your hearts
- Establishes you in every good word and work

Your hope is not in this government or the Constitution. Your hope is in the Lord — a good hope that assures you of the return of your victorious Savior.

# Discuss and apply

*2 Thessalonians 2:13–17 · from the study's posted questions and applications*

## Discuss

1. How should we determine the meaning of “salvation,” and what does it mean in 2:13?

2. What five things does the teacher say we must do with the Word so that it does not slip away?

## Apply

**Read “Saved” in Context**
Work through the handout passages this week, asking “saved from what?” for each one.

**Five Steps to Holding the Word**
Write down one truth, review it daily, and share it with one person before next week.

**In one line:** Loved, chosen, set apart and appointed to deliverance — so stand fast, hold the Word, and draw on His love, comfort and good hope.